▶ NCRB REPORT

THE BIG SHIFT IN CRIME

Overall cognisable crimes in India, registered under the Indian Penal Code/ Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and Special and Local Laws, fell 6 per cent in 2024 from the previous year, according to the latest National Crime Records Bureau data. However, the report points to a sharp shift in the nature of offences: while cybercrime, juvenile crime and cases of missing children rose, murder, rape, cruelty by husbands or relatives and dowry deaths showed a decline.

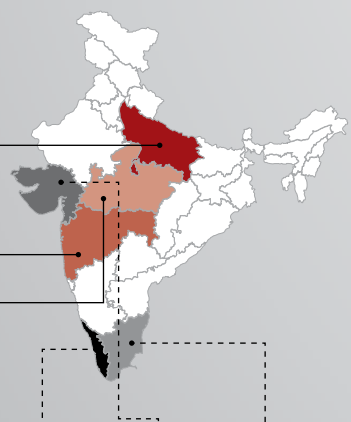
Text by **AMITABH SRIVASTAVA**
Graphic by **TANMOY CHAKRABORTY**

418.9
India's crime rate per 100,000 population in 2024, down from 448.3 in 2023

6%
drop in cognisable crime cases, from 6,241,569 in 2023 to 5,885,867 in 2024

STATES WITH HIGHEST NUMBER OF CASES

Uttar Pradesh **430,552**
Maharashtra **383,044**
Madhya Pradesh **282,874**



STATES WITH MAXIMUM CRIME RATE*

Kerala	Gujarat	Tamil Nadu
1,389	847	655.4

** Per 100,000 population*



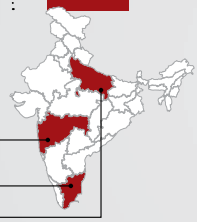
CRIMES AGAINST CHILDREN

SEXUAL OFFENCES*

2024	2023	
69,191	67,694	2.2%

TOP 3 STATES

Maharashtra **9,432**
Uttar Pradesh **8,087**
Tamil Nadu **6,969**



** Under the POCSO Act*

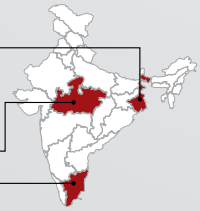
MISSING CHILDREN

2024	2023	
98,375*	91,296	7.8%

** Includes 75,603 girls*

TOP 3 STATES

West Bengal **15,849**
Madhya Pradesh **14,296**
Tamil Nadu **8,032**



JUVENILE CRIME

2024	2023	
34,878	31,365	11.2%

TOP 3 STATES

Bihar **5,037**
Maharashtra **3,779**
Madhya Pradesh **3,474**

